



Niagara Falls

A powerful and world-famous waterfall system with one of the highest flow rates of any waterfall on Earth



△ HORSESHOE FALLS

Visitors can experience the incredible power of Niagara Falls by taking a boat trip to Horseshoe Falls—one of the world's most accessible natural wonders.

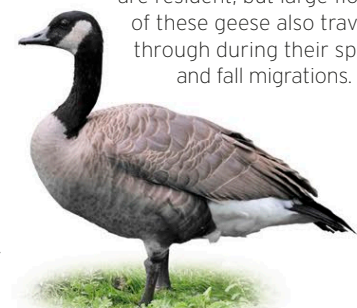
Niagara Falls is a system of three waterfalls located on the Niagara River, through which water flows from Lake Erie into Lake Ontario. The falls lie on the Canada–U.S. border and form the southern end of the Niagara Gorge.

The Horseshoe Falls, the largest of the three, has a dramatic crest line that is 2,200 ft (670 m) wide and a vertical drop of more than 188 ft (57 m) into a plunge

pool 115 ft (35 m) deep. Separated by Goat Island, the American Falls and the diminutive Bridal Veil Falls crash down 66–115 ft (20–35 m) onto a talus—a slope of rocks—formed by a huge rock slide in 1954. At peak times, about 45 million gallons (170 million liters) of water pass over the three falls each minute.

▽ DISTINCTIVE GOOSE

The Canada goose is one of the most conspicuous birds in the Niagara Falls area. Some are resident, but large flocks of these geese also travel through during their spring and fall migrations.



THE RETREATING FALLS

The great erosive power of Niagara Falls is demonstrated by its fast rate of movement, tracked since the end of the 17th century. It is estimated that, at the present rate of erosion, the falls will reach Lake Erie about 50,000 years from now.



Cutting back

Niagara Falls was formed as the Niagara River plunged over a huge escarpment on its way to the Atlantic Ocean. In a process that continues today, the river eroded layers of soft rock sitting below a harder dolomite caprock. As the soft layers eroded, undercutting the dolomite above, great chunks of the caprock gave way, leaving a vertical cliff face.

Niagara Falls has **retreated 7 miles (11 km)** over the last **12,500 years**